

DecisionIQ Master Handbook

CHAPTER 3: Defining DecisionIQ: Dashboards vs. BI vs. Decision Intelligence

3.1 Defining Decision Intelligence

Decision Intelligence (DI) is a practical discipline used to improve decision-making by using data engineering, advanced SQL, machine learning, and business logic. While traditional Business Intelligence (BI) stops at presenting charts, Decision Intelligence models the decisions themselves, linking actions to measurable financial outcomes.

3.2 Feature Comparison

Feature	Traditional Dashboards	Business Intelligence (BI)	Decision Intelligence (DI)
Primary Goal	Display operational data.	Summarize historical trends.	Optimize business outcomes.
Output Type	Raw numbers and charts.	Aggregated KPIs and lines.	Diagnostic reports & actions.
Temporal Focus	Present (Real-time snapshots).	Past (Historical reporting).	Future & Prescriptive.
User Action	Manual guessing.	Manual drill-downs.	Selecting recommended actions.

3.3 A Real-World Example

- **Dashboard View:** West Coast delivery delays have increased by 3.2 days.
- **BI View:** Delays are concentrated in hardware shipments out of warehouse WH002.
- **DecisionIQ View:** Delays are caused by understaffing at WH002 and parts delays from Apex Tech. This puts \$150,000 in customer ARR at risk. **Recommendation:** Switch 40% of component volume to EuroChip AG and shift 15% safety stock from East Coast.

3.4 Interview Tips

[!TIP] **Q: How does Decision Intelligence differ from traditional Business Intelligence?**
Model Answer: BI reports historical data and leaves the interpretation and decisions to humans. DI models the decisions themselves, using predictive machine learning and heuristic diagnostic engines to automate root-cause identification and prescribe specific actions with calculated financial benefits.